

The logbook of the project:

Sailing Logbook

Yacht:

MMSI:

Call Sign:

Home Port:

Start Date:

End Date:

Sailing Area:

Charter Company:

Captain:

Crew List:

1.

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12.
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Belgian Sailing Community



NATO Phonetic Alphabet

A - Alfa	N - November
B - Bravo	O - Oscar
C - Charlie	P - Papa
D - Delta	Q - Quebec
E - Echo	R - Romeo
F - Foxtrot	S - Sierra
G - Golf	T - Tango
H - Hotel	U - Uniform
I - India	V - Victor
J - Juliett	W - Whiskey
K - Kilo	X - X-ray
L - Lima	Y - Yankee
M - Mike	Z - Zulu



EMERGENCY RADIO CALL

USE ONLY IN CASE OF DANGER TO LIFE. SPEAK SLOWLY.

1. PRESS AND HOLD THE RED BUTTON ON THE RADIO UNTIL IT BEEPS.

2. SWITCH RADIO CHANNEL TO 16, PRESS “PUSH-TO-TALK” AND READ:

*“MAYDAY, MAYDAY, MAYDAY
THIS IS YACHT , YACHT , YACHT”*

3. READ GPS POSITION AND REPORT IT:

*“MY POSITION IS ... DEGREES ... MINUTES NORTH
... DEGREES ... MINUTES EAST”*

4. SAY WHAT HAPPENED:

*“WE HAVE ... [Fire / Sinking / Person Overboard / Medical
Emergency]”*

5. WHAT DO YOU WANT?

*“WE REQUIRE ... [Immediate Rescue / Towing / Medical
Advice]”*

“WE HAVE 13 PERSONS ON BOARD.”

6. SAY “OVER” AND RELEASE THE “PUSH-TO-TALK” BUTTON.

No answer? Repeat every 2 minutes. Stay on CH16.



Crew Briefing – Captain’s Checkpoints (1/2)

Captain’s Tip: A full briefing can take a significant amount of time. To speed up the process, consider “Stations”: Assign each Watch Officer a specific section to explain. The crew can rotate between stations (e.g., Life Saving, Emergency Proc, Yacht Basics) in small groups. This keeps everyone engaged and finishes the briefing much faster.

Life Saving Equipment

- ☐ **Life Jackets:** Each assigned to a cabin; always worn at night and in bad weather. Show: how to fasten, adjust, whistle, and sprayhood.
- ☐ **Life Raft:** Location and release method. Use only on Captain’s command – gather at the stern, EPIRB activated, bring grab-bag.
- ☐ **Life-lines & Harnesses:** How to clip into jacklines; mandatory on deck at night and sea state ≥ 4 .
- ☐ **Pyrotechnics:** Location of rockets/flares/smoke; fire with wind at back, gloves on, only after VHF coordination.
- ☐ **VHF Radio (DSC):** CH16 monitoring; MAYDAY format. Practice DISTRESS button use.
- ☐ **EPIRB / SART / PLB:** Check what’s on board. EPIRB (auto/manual), SART (for raft), PLB (personal).

Emergency Procedures

- ☐ **Water Ingress:** Taste test – salty (external leak) or fresh (plumbing). Close seacocks, cut unnecessary power, start bilge pumps, locate source.
- ☐ **MOB (Man Overboard):** Shout “Man Overboard!”, point, MOB button on plotter, throw lifebuoy/light. Approach maneuver – one person commands, others quiet.
- ☐ **Fire:** Alarm, cut source (gas/electric/engine), use correct extinguisher (powder/CO₂), shut air supply. Everyone in cockpit in life jackets.
- ☐ **Evacuation:** 1st Officer (EPIRB/Raft), 2nd Officer (Grab-bag/Food/Docs), 3rd Officer (Pyrotechnics/Torches/VHF). Count crew.



Crew Briefing – Captain’s Checkpoints (2/2)

Life On Board – Rules

- ☐ **Forgive minor faults:** It’s a week together; speak directly and calmly.
- ☐ **Watches & Sleeping:** Shared cabins, quiet hours; ALWAYS wake the Captain if in doubt.
- ☐ **Water & Toilets:** Conserve water; follow yacht toilet rules (no paper in the bowl).
- ☐ **Gas Stove:** Cut source (valve) first, then the burner. Fire extinguisher and blanket ready.
- ☐ **Damage:** Shared responsibility; insurance deposit, but report everything immediately (photos, time, circumstances).

Yacht Basics

- ☐ **Knots:** Cleat hitch (mooring lines), Bowline (loop). Practice with eyes closed.
- ☐ **Winches:** Line from bottom, 3–4 wraps, “on top”, fingers away. Commands: “taking/easing” – confirm loudly.
- ☐ **Port Maneuvers:** No jokes. Short, loud reports (“stern 2m, drifting left”). Wait for Captain’s confirmation.



Watch Assignments & Schedule

- (1st Officer)
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- (2nd Officer)
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- (3rd Officer)
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Watch Schedule

Date	0000 → 0400	0400 → 0800	0800 → 1200	1200 → 1400	1400 → 1600	1600 → 2000	2000 → 2400	Galley
	I	II	III	I	II	III	I	I
	II	III	I	II	III	I	II	II
	III	I	II	III	I	II	III	III
	I	II	III	I	II	III	I	I
	II	III	I	II	III	I	II	II
	III	I	II	III	I	II	III	III
	I	II	III	I	II	III	I	I
	II	III	I	II	III	I	II	II

Legend:

- **Hourly Columns:** Assigned watch takes care of all **Navigation Duties** and deck operations during these times.
- **Galley Column:** Assigned watch is responsible for **Cooking and Cleaning** for the **entire day** (from breakfast until supper, assigned watch is in charge of the kitchen).



Log Entry Guidelines

This logbook is organized into two-page spreads to make recording our journey easy. The **left page** is where we keep all the technical data—think of it as the boat’s “brain” where we track our speed, position, and engine status every hour. The **right page** is the heart of the log; use it like a journal to write down what happened during the day, tell funny stories, note down the weather, or sketch the coastline.

How to Fill the Data Columns

- **Time:** 4-digit military time (e.g., 0830, 1415).
- **Pos (Position):** Use Latitude and Longitude with precision to minutes (e.g., N44°50' E13°48') or write the name of the marina or anchorage if we are stationary.
- **HDG (Current Heading):** Our current compass heading (e.g., 210).
- **Spd (Speed):** Our instantaneous Speed Over Ground (SOG) in knots at the moment of the entry. If surfing waves, estimate a steady average.
- **Log:** The total distance from the boat’s log instrument.
- **Wind:** The direction the wind is blowing **from** and speed in knots (e.g., NW 15).
- **Sails:** Use **M** for Main and **J** for Jib. Note reefing like “M1, J1” or “-” if the sails are down.
- **Eng (Engine):** Record the current **RPM** (e.g., 1800) or simply write **OFF**.

What MUST be recorded

- **Watch Change:** The time and initials of who is taking over.
- **Arrivals & Departures:** When we leave or enter a port or anchorage.
- **Changes:** Any time the sails go up/down or the engine RPM changes.
- **Refueling:** Any time we top up the diesel or the fresh water tanks.
- **Checks:** Equipment failures or routine inspections (like battery levels).



Day 0 - Demo Notes Page

09:30 - We tried training man overboard (MOB) maneuvers. Finished with great success on the second attempt! Everyone knows their role now.

– **John Doe**

13:00 - Something funny happened: an Italian fisherman offered us a massive bluefin tuna in exchange for two of our crew members. We considered it for a moment, but decided we needed the hands for the night watch!

– **Captain Name**

18:00 - Anchored in the bay. Crystal clear water. Making dinner now.

– **Crew 1**



Day 1 - Log



Day 1 - Notes



Day 2 - Log



Day 2 - Notes



Day 3 - Log



Day 3 - Notes



Day 4 - Log



Day 4 - Notes



Day 5 - Log



Day 5 - Notes



Day 6 - Log



Day 6 - Notes



Day 7 - Log



Day 7 - Notes



Day 8 - Notes





Belgian Sailing Community

This logbook template is an open-source community project.
If you have feedback, ideas, or want to contribute to future versions, please visit:

github.com/nd-dew/sailing-logbook